

7GB of initial storage space through OneDrive with additional storage of 3 GB on backing up your Windows Phone camera and 5 GB for referring friends.

Given these pros and cons, it's hard to predict how well users would take to Microsoft's Office Online in the long run when they have Google Drive as an option but that's a question of personal preference more than technical competency, as far as casual users are concerned.

iWork for iCloud

Since its inception, Apple has created a closed and almost secretive world around its OS X platform. The closed systems and comparatively limited software options have always tilted the market in the favour of PCs, especially Microsoft with its productivity office suites. However, with the recent proliferations of iPhones and iPads in the mobile markets, Apple has once again gained centre stage in the enterprise productivity market as tablets have become more work friendly. In this regard, Apple's iWorks for iCloud is a serious entrant into the world of cloud-based office suites.

iWork for iCloud was launched in 2013. Prior to this, the tightly knit suite with its three applications – Pages (word processor), Numbers (spreadsheets) and Keynote (presentation) – had long been a favourite of Mac users everywhere but wasn't available online. This development mainly meant that users on other operating systems could use iWorks through their browsers and not necessarily require an OS X machine. This news in itself caused waves as Apple's iWork had long been regarded as a great product in function and form.

The app-based releases of iWorks for Mac machines that soon followed were designed to be sync-friendly making the transition of work files across platforms much easier than ever before. Along with this, the support for Microsoft Office files by Apple's iWorks allowing for an easy drag-and-drop action makes its value even more appealing. As of at the moment, this service is still in its Beta testing phase but lots of information regarding the expected functionality, performance and look has already been made available.

The basic requirements for using iWorks on iCloud are an Apple ID and login to your iCloud account, which presents you with 5 GB of free storage. However, it should be noted that this singular account is linked across all your iOS devices and is used for backups as well. This simply means that 5 GB may not be enough storage since image and video backups as well as mobile device backups are being done using this same account.

The ability to use the browser as a means to work on iWork-related files means huge opportunities for team collaborations. Since users with different